

NQ Liquidity Sweep & Reversal Scalping Strategy

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Scalping \$2.5M Payouts: ICT Strategy Breakdown

Summary of the video "Trading LIVE With The World's #1 Prop Firm Scalper (\$2.5M+ Payouts)" by Chart Fanatics.

World-class prop firm scalper Candice BL reveals her ICT-based scalping strategy that generated \$1.1M+ payouts. She trades London and New York sessions using liquidity sweeps, fair value gaps, and strict rules around entry timing (2am EST kill zone), position sizing, and profit targets. Key insight: follow your process and personality, not greed—\$4k in 9 minutes beats \$20k in 4 hours of mental fatigue.

The ICT Scalping Foundation

What ICT Concept Really Means

ICT teaches that markets are run by algorithms targeting and creating liquidity (stop orders at swing highs/lows). Traders use this to identify where price will sweep before reversing. The strategy focuses on accumulation, manipulation, and distribution (AMD) phases across sessions.

London Kill Zone: The Core Trading Window

Candice only trades London session between 2am–5am EST. She avoids pre-2am setups despite temptation because they occur at lower frequency and lead to overtrading. This strict discipline prevents revenge trading and losses.

Why 1-Minute plus 15-Second Monitoring Works

Candice enters on 1-minute charts but monitors 15-second and 30-second timeframes to see displacement and speed—information invisible on higher timeframes. This is not noise; it reveals the true momentum and confirms valid entries without being too aggressive.

The Entry Model: Three Pillars

Higher Timeframe Analysis (Weekly, Daily, 1-Hour)

Candice uses daily candles and 1-hour fair value gaps (FVGs) as internal liquidity targets. She also marks the 1-hour FVG on every chart; if price enters it during a trade, she closes at least half the position. This prevents overextension.

Premium/Discount Zones and Liquidity Pools

After identifying where price has swept liquidity (Asia high/low, swing highs/lows), Candice waits for a low-resistance liquidity run (LL)—a series of equal highs or lows showing price is building momentum. This confirms a reversal is imminent.

Fair Value Gap and Inverted FVG Entries

A bearish FVG forms when price gaps down without filling the gap. When a bullish candle closes above it, it becomes an inverted FVG—a valid entry. Aggressive traders enter inside the gap; conservative traders wait for the candle to fully close above it.

Risk Management and Trade Execution

Fixed Stop Loss Rules by Session

London session: 20–25 point max stop loss. New York session: 30–40 points (higher volatility). If she needs a larger stop to enter, it is not the right entry. This rule forces her to wait for tighter setups and prevents poor risk-reward trades.

Minimum 1:2 Risk-to-Reward; Adjust to Liquidity

Candice uses bracket orders with a 1:2 minimum ratio but adjusts the take-profit to the closest higher timeframe liquidity pool. If the pool is 1:3 or 1:4, she extends the target accordingly.

Proactive Stop Loss Trailing

Once a minor liquidity sweep occurs (visible on 15-second charts), Candice trails her stop to a tighter level—sometimes to break-even. This preserves capital and mental health if the trade reverses, allowing her to re-enter on the next setup.

Position Sizing: Confidence Determines Contracts

A+ setups with multiple confluences: 5 contracts with tight stop. B/C setups with fewer confluences: 2 contracts. She scales in on additional FVGs if they appear. On a 50k prop account, she trades 2 contracts despite others calling it aggressive—justified by low volatility in London session.

Daily Loss Limit (Dollar-Based, Not Trade Count)

On a 150k account with 160k total balance, Candice sets a 3,000 USD daily loss limit. Once hit, she stops trading. This prevents emotional revenge trading and protects the account from catastrophic drawdown.

Profit Targets and Trade Management

Close at First Target, Not the Whole Move

Candice targets only 5–10 percent of a daily move and closes when hit. She does not aim for 100–200 points. This mindset prevents her from holding through hours of choppy price action and mental fatigue. She accepts leaving money on the table to preserve mental capital.

Why Holding Longer Costs More Than It Gains

A 4,000 USD win in 9 minutes is superior to a 20,000 USD win in 4 hours because the latter involves watching P&L swing up and down, second-guessing, and risking emotional mistakes. The mental cost of holding through retracements often leads to break-even or losses.

Scaling Out on Partial Targets

Candice often takes partial profits at the first internal liquidity or swing high, then moves her stop to break-even or trails it lower. This locks in wins and gives the remaining contracts room to run without risk.

New York Session Strategy (Pre-Market and Open)

RTH Gap as Reference, Not Guarantee

The regular trading hours (RTH) gap—the gap between 4pm close and 9:30am open—is marked in quarters (25 percent, 50 percent, 75 percent, 100 percent). Candice uses it as a directional reference and potential target, but price does not always close the gap. She targets the 75 percent level or a swing high instead.

Speed and Displacement: Why Seconds Matter

New York open moves fast. Candice monitors 15-second and 30-second charts to catch the displacement and speed of the initial candles. Missing this information means missing the entry entirely. She enters on 1-minute close but uses lower timeframes to confirm.

Why She Does Not Live Stream New York

New York trades end within 10–15 minutes. Streaming would end before she could engage with chat. More importantly, her focus must be 100 percent on execution; splitting attention with chat would degrade her trading. Trading comes first, content second.

Psychology and Personality-Driven Rules

Understand Your Personality First

Candice is someone who gets frustrated by break-even trades and does not like trailing stop losses for hours. She built her model around this: quick exits, small targets, tight stops. Other traders may prefer holding longer; they should adjust their rules accordingly. There is no one-size-fits-all strategy.

Adapt Your Model to Your Lifestyle

Candice lives in Asia, so New York open is 10:30pm—end of her day. She chose to trade London (2–5am) and early New York instead of grinding all day. This choice aligns with her energy and prevents burnout. Traders must choose sessions that fit their life, not force themselves into misaligned schedules.

Back-Testing Multiple Templates

Candice tested different exit strategies: closing at 5–10 percent move, trailing stops, holding for full daily range. Back-testing revealed which template matched her personality and produced the best results. She then practiced with demo before risking real money.

Mental Capital Greater Than Monetary Capital

Candice prioritizes mental health over maximum profit. If a trade hurts her mental capital (even if she breaks even), she stops trading for the day. This prevents the spiral of revenge trading and account blowups. Protecting psychology is protecting the account.

ICT Twitter Spaces: The Real Education

Candice credits ICT's Twitter Spaces (not YouTube videos) as the breakthrough. ICT discusses trading psychology, personal life impact on performance, and mindset—not just strategy. This depth changed her perspective from 'learn strategy equals become profitable' to 'understand yourself equals execute consistently.'

Real Trade Examples: London and New York

Trade 1: \$4,000 in 9 Minutes (London, A+ Setup)

Candice swept the Asia high, saw a bearish FVG with a small wick, got a bullish FVG confirmation, and entered. She closed at the second swing high after 9 minutes for \$4,000. Price later retracted back to entry, proving her exit was correct.

Trade 2: \$4,000 in 12 Minutes (London, Buy Setup)

Similar structure: liquidity sweep, LL run, FVG entry. Candice closed at the first swing high. Price continued lower for another 30 minutes, but she avoided the mental fatigue and retracement risk by exiting early.

Trade 3: \$17,000–\$20,000 in 10 Minutes (New York, A+ Setup)

Multiple confluences: daily FVG sweep, 1-hour FVG fill, RTH gap reference, outage gap reference. Candice entered with 5 contracts (high confidence) and a tight 20-point stop. She held longer than usual because the setup was so strong, but still exited before price retracted.

Trade 4: \$2,700 in 2 Minutes (New York Open, C Setup)

Candice entered a C setup (lower probability) with 2 contracts. She took partial profit at the first target, then moved stop to break-even. She closed the final contract at the second target. Even though it was lower probability, the quick win and tight risk made it worthwhile.

Trade 5: \$37,000 in 11 Minutes (New York, A+ Setup with Scale-In)

Candice entered the first FVG with 2 contracts, then scaled in 3 more on a second FVG confirmation. Multiple timeframe confluences (daily FVG, 1-hour FVG, RTH gap, outage gap) aligned. She held longer than usual and closed at the 75 percent RTH gap level. This was an exceptional setup.

Copy Trading and Multi-Account Scaling

Apex Trader Funding: 20 Accounts, 100 Percent Payouts

Apex allows traders to get up to 20 funded accounts (no other firm offers this). Candice uses copy trading to replicate her trades across accounts. A \$4,000 trade on one account becomes \$80,000 across 20 accounts. Apex pays 100 percent of approved payouts with no discretionary denials.

Payout Record: \$2.5M Single Payout (Jadecap)

Apex holds the record for largest single payout: \$2.5M to Jadecap. Candice herself has generated \$1.1M+ payouts using this exact strategy. The firm has paid out over \$600M total to traders worldwide.

Why Copy Trading Multiplies Edge

Instead of grinding one account, Candice trades 20 accounts with the same strategy. A \$4,000 scalp becomes \$80,000. This removes pressure to hold for bigger moves and lets her stick to her process: quick, consistent wins across multiple accounts.

Key Mindset Shifts

Process Over Outcome

Candice focuses on following her rules, not on hitting a specific profit target. If she enters an A+ setup with proper risk management and exits at her target, she has won—regardless of whether price goes higher later. The process is the edge.

Base Hits, Not Home Runs

Most trades are base hits—small, consistent wins. Home runs (big moves) happen rarely. Traders who chase home runs every trade end up overtrading and losing. Candice's strategy is built on base hits; home runs are a bonus.

Discipline Over Temptation

Candice refuses to trade before 2am EST even if a setup looks perfect. She refuses to hold for the entire daily range even if price keeps going. These rules exist because she has seen the cost of breaking them. Discipline is the real edge.

Master One Timeframe Before Moving Down

Candice started on 5-minute, mastered it, then moved to 1-minute, then to 30-second and 15-second. She did not skip steps. Beginners who jump straight to 15-second charts without mastering 1-minute will fail. The progression is non-negotiable.

Notable quotes

If I had to use a larger stop loss to enter, that means that is not the entry point. — Candice BL

I'm not only taking A+ setups but also B+ and C setups. Even A+ setups can turn into losing trades. — Candice BL

You have to master timing first. If you miss this information, you will just miss the entry. — Candice BL

Action items

Identify your personality type: Are you frustrated by break-even trades? Do you hate trailing stops? Do you prefer quick exits? Build your rules around this, not against it.

Choose a trading session that fits your lifestyle and timezone. Do not force yourself into a misaligned schedule.

Back-test at least 3 different exit templates (e.g., close at 5 percent, trail stops, hold for full range) and compare results. Use the data to pick your strategy.

Practice on demo with your chosen timeframe progression (5-min to 1-min to 30-sec to 15-sec). Do not skip steps.

Set a fixed daily loss limit in dollars (not trade count). Once hit, close the platform and stop trading.

Mark your higher timeframe liquidity (daily FVG, 1-hour FVG, RTH gap, midnight opening price) on your chart before each session.

On your first 20 trades, focus only on A+ setups with multiple confluences. Do not take B or C setups until you have proven consistency.

Record your first 10 live trades and review them. Note where you exited early, where you held too long, and how your emotions affected decisions.

If trading prop, calculate your position size based on your account size and daily loss limit. Use copy trading (if available) to multiply consistent edge across accounts.

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